NOTE There are two popular ingress controllers based on NGINX. The Ingress NGINX project (https://github.com/kubernetes/ingress-nginx) is developed, supported, and maintained in the Kubernetes project itself. It's open source, and it's what we'll use in this book. The NGINX Controller (www.nginx.com/products/nginx-controller) is a product developed and maintained by the F5 NGINX company, and it comes with free and commercial options.

Let's see how we can use Ingress NGINX on our local Kubernetes cluster. An ingress controller is a workload just like any other application running on Kubernetes, and it can be deployed in different ways. The simplest option would be using kubectl to apply its deployment manifests to the cluster. Since we use minikube to manage a local Kubernetes cluster, we can rely on a built-in add-on to enable the Ingress functionality based on Ingress NGINX.

First, let's start the `polar` local cluster we introduced in chapter 7. Since we configured minikube to run on Docker, make sure your Docker Engine is up and running:

```
$ minikube start --cpus 2 --memory 4g --driver docker --profile polar
```

Next we can enable the `ingress` add-on, which will make sure that Ingress NGINX is deployed to our local cluster:

```
$ minikube addons enable ingress --profile polar
```

In the end, you can get information about the different components deployed with Ingress NGINX as follows:

```
$ kubectl get all -n ingress-nginx
```

The preceding command contains an argument we haven't encountered yet: `-n ingress-nginx`. It means that we want to fetch all objects created in the `ingress-nginx` *namespace*.